

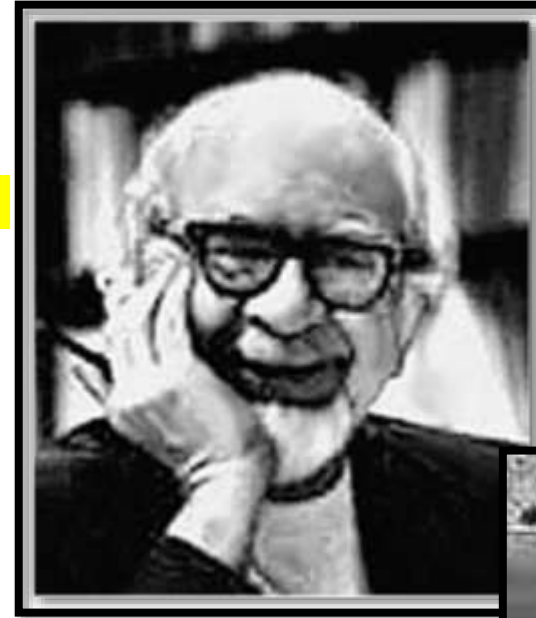
Communication Models Continued + Organisational Communication

The Westley and Maclean model of communication

The Westley and Maclean communication model suggests that the communication process **does not start with the source/sender, but rather with environmental factors.**

This model also considers the object of the orientation (background, culture, and beliefs) of the sender and the receivers.

The process of communication, according to this model, **starts with environmental factors that influence the speaker — the culture or society the speaker lives in, whether the speaker is in a public or private space, etc.**



Main Features of this model

This model consists of 9 crucial components:

Environment (X1, X2, X3, etc.) – External stimuli or events that influence communication.

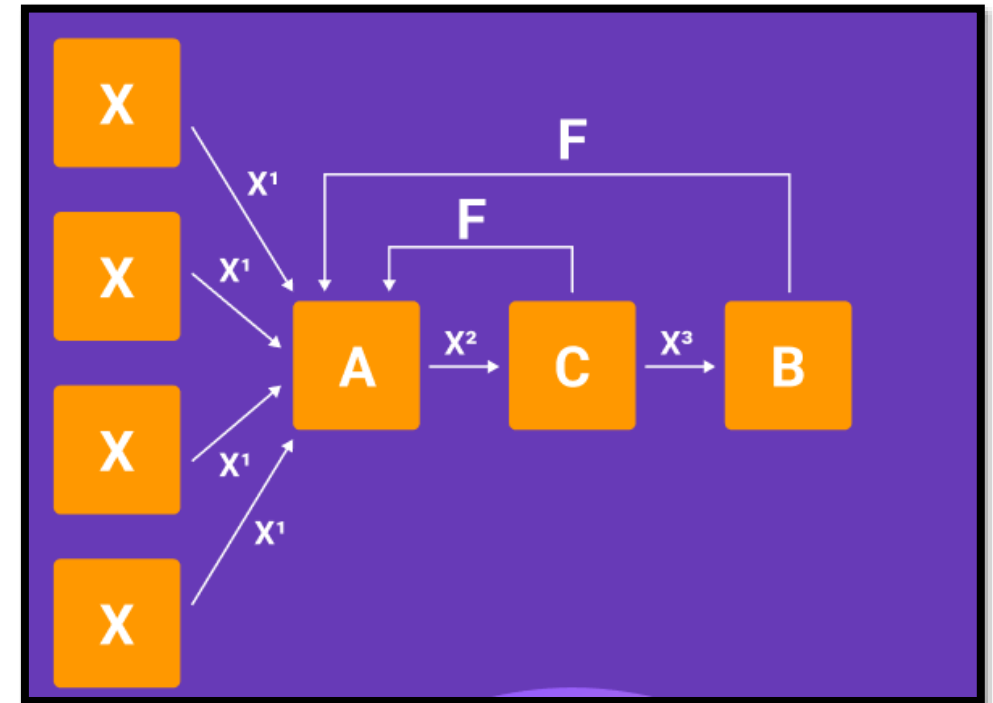
Source (A) – The person or entity initiating the communication by responding to stimuli.

Message (X') – The information being communicated, shaped by the source's interpretation.

Receiver (B) – The person or audience interpreting the message.

Gatekeeper (C) – An intermediary (e.g., editor, media outlet, manager) who filters or alters the message before it reaches the receiver.

Feedback (fBA and fAB) – The responses exchanged between sender and receiver, ensuring communication is dynamic rather than one-way.



Transactional Communication Models

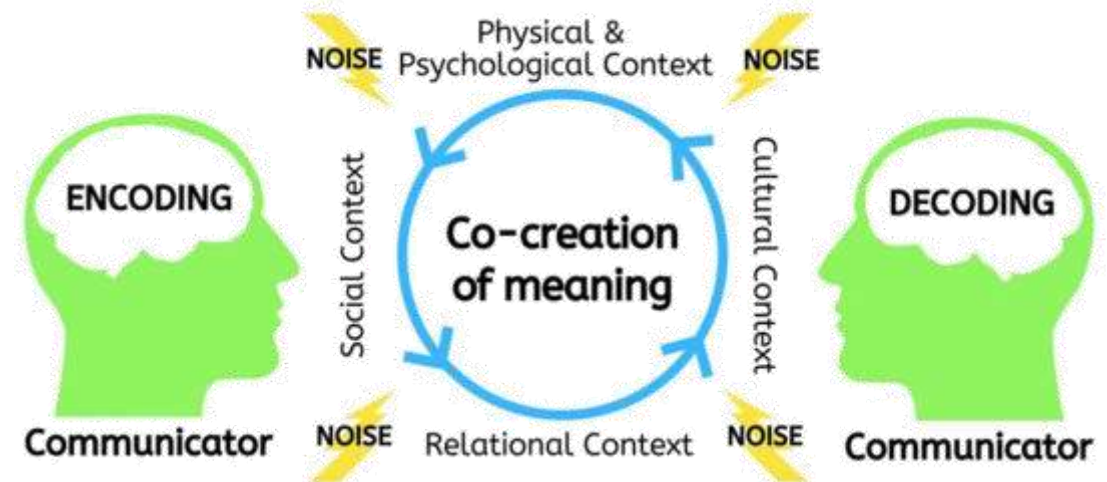
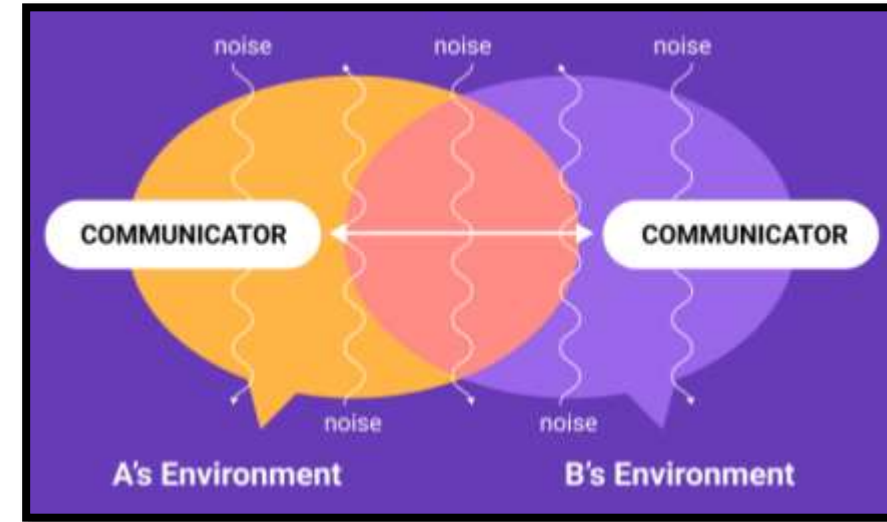
Transactional models are the most dynamic communication models, which introduce a new term for senders and receivers, known as “Communicators”.

Transactional communication models view communication as a transaction, meaning that it is a cooperative process in which communicators **co-create the process of communication together, thereby influencing its outcome and effectiveness.**

Transactional models show that we do not just exchange information during our interactions, but create relationships, form cross-cultural bonds, and shape our opinions.

Transactional models also introduced the roles of:

- Social
- Relational
- Cultural contexts.



Barnlund's transactional model of communication

Barnlund's Transactional Model of Communication is a dynamic that emphasises the simultaneous exchange of messages between communicators. The model highlights the continuous, reciprocal nature of communication.

Barnlund's transactional communication model illustrates the following main components of this communication model:

- Encoding,
- Decoding,
- Communicators,
- The message (including the cues, environment, and noise), and
- The channel.

Main takeaways of Barnlund's Model

- **Simultaneous Sending and Receiving** – Communication is a two-way process where both participants act as senders and receivers at the same time.
- **Multidimensional Messages** – Messages are conveyed through multiple channels, including verbal and nonverbal cues (e.g., facial expressions, gestures, tone of voice).
- **Context Dependency** – Communication is influenced by the psychological, relational, social, and cultural context in which it occurs.
- **Noise and Feedback** – Barriers (noise) can distort communication, while feedback helps participants adjust their messages for clarity.
- **Cues and Codes** – People interpret messages using public cues (shared symbols, language), private cues (personal thoughts and emotions), and behavioral cues (body language, facial expressions).
- **Continuous Process** – Communication does not have a clear beginning or end but flows continuously as participants react and respond.

Dance's Helical Model of Communication

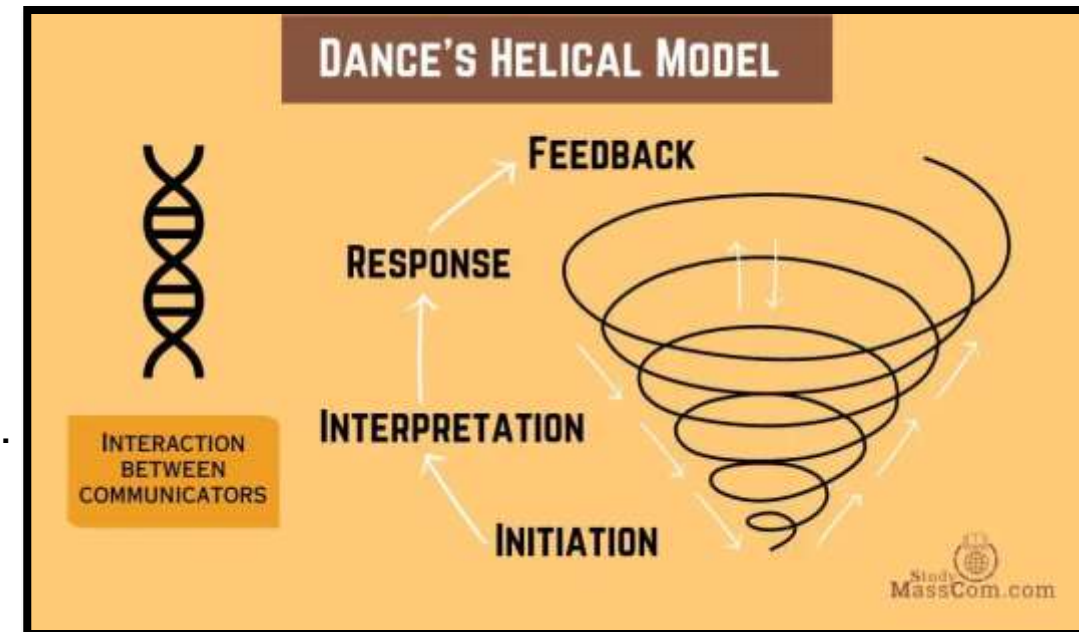
Dance's Helical Model of Communication (1967) presents communication as a **continuous, evolving, and cyclical process**.

Unlike linear, it emphasises how communication expands over time, much like a growing helix (spiral).



Main points of Dance's Helical Model of Communication

- **Evolutionary Process** – Communication is not static; it builds upon past interactions and improves over time as individuals gain experience.
- **Circular and Expanding** – Like a helix, communication moves forward while looping back, meaning past experiences influence future communication.
- **No Clear Beginning or End** – Unlike linear models, there is no single starting point; communication starts from birth and develops through accumulated experiences.
- **Memory and Learning** – Previous interactions shape how we communicate in the future, making it a learning-driven process.
- **Gradual Improvement** – Effective communication takes time, experience, and feedback, leading to better clarity and understanding over time.



Homework for Monday: Modern Communications Operating Model

The Government Communication Service (GCS) published the 'Modern Communications Operating Model: A blueprint for government communication'.

The model sets out the fundamental disciplines and practices for effective public service communications.

Read the article to establish a better understanding of this modern communication model.



SCAN ME

Homework: Modern Communication Operation Model

The Modern Communications Operating Model is a comprehensive framework developed by the Government Communication Service (GCS) to guide government communicators in delivering effective and efficient public service communications.

This model was launched in July 2023, and consolidates essential policies, guidance, and tools into a user-friendly resource accessible to all communication professionals across government departments and Arm's-Length Bodies (ALBs).

Homework: Research the framework and answer the following

1. What are the key components of the Modern Communications Operating Model, and how do they contribute to effective communication within government organisations?
2. How has the adoption of this model influenced the effectiveness of government communication?
3. What potential future developments or revisions could further improve this model? How might emerging technologies (e.g., AI, data analytics) shape its evolution?

Please write your answers on our Teams Channel



Changing People's Behaviours through Frame, Narrative and Messages

- **Frame:** The perspective through which people interpret facts
- **Narrative:** The more detailed explanation of how things are, which draws out the situation, the journey and the benefit, and possibly ties it all together with some history or a story.
- **Messages:** The way the narrative is dissipated, conveyed.



Source: (Dewhurst & Fitzpatrick, 2022)

Frame, Narrative and Messages –Activity

10mins + Discussion

- To understand the concept of Frame, Narrative and Message read the excerpt from Dewhurst and Fitzpatrick (2022) uploaded onto Teams.

Pair up and discuss:

1. What was the initial Frame the Employees had about own Health and Safety precautions?
2. What was the New Frame that the HSE Manager introduced? Why did it work?
3. What Narrative (Story) helped the change in employee behaviour?
4. How was the narrative dissipated/conveyed/distributed?



Source: (Dewhurst & Fitzpatrick, 2022)

Creating a Narrative

- The Business: An International Relief Charity
- Objective: Introduction of the Performance Management Programme
- Employee Frame: we help people, we don't need performance management as we act of the goodness of our hearts and not for profit, a charity organisation is not concerned with performance like corporate for-profit businesses are

OUR CHALLENGE

A description of the world we're in – customers, competitors, stakeholders and what they expect of us

What is coming – the **factual** and **emotional** reasons why we can't stand still and the potential opportunity to be grasped

OUR DESTINATION

What our future looks like – a factual description of where we need to get to

Evidence of our **commitment** to the destination

THE JOURNEY

The **steps** we will have to take and the **staging posts** along the way

The **support** we will have along the way and the **strengths** we will draw upon

The **risks** we face if we waver or weaken

THE PRIZE

What will the final destination **feel** like and what **material benefits** will it bring to us, to the people we care about and the world which we serve?

Why we should have **faith** that we will reach our goal

The task 20mins: In groups of 3/4, choose one of the below scenarios spend 20 mins on **discussing, gathering ideas and then writing a short memo** (you can use the template provided on Teams) to the employees with the aim of them accepting your initiative by 'playing' with their frame. **What other channels would you use to reinforce the message?**

Scenario 1: 'Imagine your staff are tired of abuse from customers. They say they get too many phone calls from people who are demanding and possibly (in some cases) stupid.

You want to create a 'care' programme to help them. How would you do this knowing the narrative would you use?

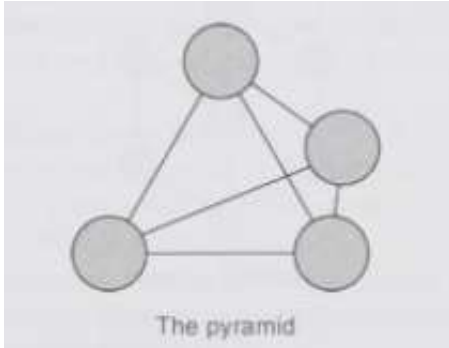
Remember that attempting at changing people's frame directly by contradicting it i.e. customers are not annoying or stupid, or management are not trying to 'get you' is usually not effective. You need to work with the frame your employees have....

Scenario 2: imagine that your workers believe senior managers are always looking for ways to make them work longer hours for less money.

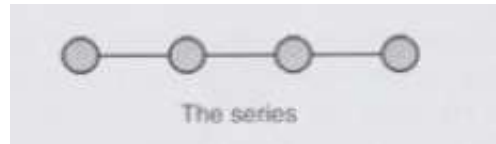
How would you design the narrative and you construct to convince them to work longer hours and a pay-structure?

Scenario 3: Imagine you want to turn your current charity programme into an International Relief Charity. However, your employees believe that 'we are a charity, we don't need performance management as we act of the goodness of our hearts' and 'we are not for profit, a charity organisation is not concerned with performance, like corporate for-profit businesses are' How would you use this frame to change their minds?

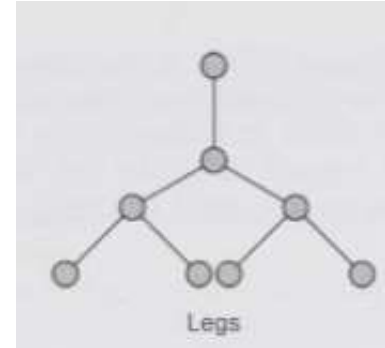
Organisational Communication Patterns



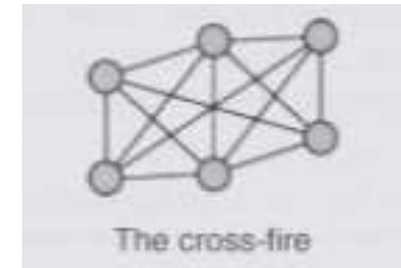
Team leader and a small team,
in bigger teams similar to legs



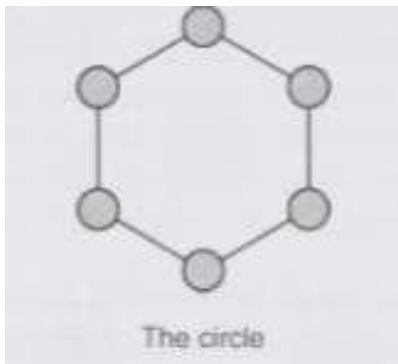
Gossip



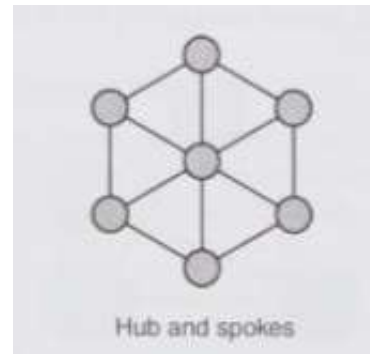
Hierarchy,
procedural



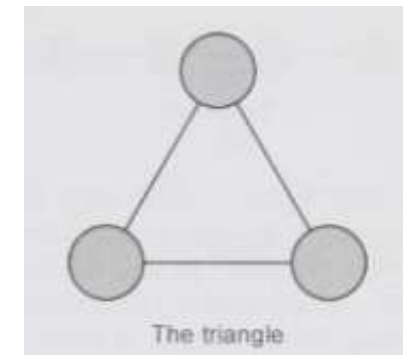
Flat, self-organising team, creative,
innovation



Procedures, Compliance checks i.e.
banks



Expert,
communication
guardian,
Project
Manager, Head
office and
regional offices,
distribution hub



small team,
informal
colleagues

(Brounstein, Bell & Smith, 2007)

Let's play

Go to Kahoot.it

Activity 10 mins – 3 Groups

Communication	Pros	Cons
Upward Communication		
Downward Communication		
Lateral Communication		

Split into 3 groups. Each group selects a different direction of communication and proposes

- Benefits and Disadvantages of that direction of communication.
- What situations would it be useful and where less useful?

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